Leadership

What Is Leadership?

- Leadership
  - The ability to influence a group toward the achievement of goals
- Management
  - Use of authority inherent in designated formal rank to obtain compliance from organizational members

Trait Theories of Leadership

- Theories that consider personality, social, physical, or intellectual traits to differentiate leaders from non-leaders
- Leadership Traits
  - Extroversion
  - Conscientiousness
  - Openness
  - Emotional Intelligence (Qualified)-ability, to identify, assess, and manage the emotions of one's self, of others, and of groups
- Traits can predict leadership, but they are better at predicting leader emergence than effectiveness.

Behavioral Theories of Leadership

- Theories proposing that specific behaviors differentiate leaders from non-leaders
- Differences between Trait and Behavior theories of leadership?

Important Behavioral Studies

- Ohio State University
  - Found two key dimensions of leader behavior:
    - Initiating structure – the defining and structuring of roles
    - Consideration – job relationships that reflect trust and respect
    - Both are important
- University of Michigan
  - Also found two key dimensions of leader behavior:
    - Employee-oriented – emphasizes interpersonal relationships and is the most powerful dimension
    - Production-oriented – emphasizes the technical aspects of the job
  - The dimensions of the two studies are very similar

Contingency Theories

- While trait and behavior theories do help us understand leadership, an important component is missing: the environment in which the leader exists
- Contingency Theory deals with this additional aspect of leadership effectiveness studies

Fiedler Model

- Effective group performance depends on the proper match between leadership style and the situation
  - Assumes that leadership style is fixed
- Considers Three Situational Factors:
  - Leader-member relations: degree of confidence and trust in the leader
  - Task structure: degree of structure in the jobs
  - Position power: leader's ability to hire, fire, and reward
- *For effective leadership: must change to a leader who fits the situation or change the situational variables to fit the current leader*

Leader-Member Exchange (LMX) Theory

- LMX Premise:
  - Because of time pressures, leaders form a special relationship with a small group of followers: the “in-group”
  - This in-group is trusted and gets more time and attention from the leader (more “exchanges”)
  - All other followers are in the “out-group” and get less of the leader’s attention and tend to have formal relationships with the leader (fewer “exchanges”)
  - Leaders pick group members early in the relationship

Charismatic Leadership

- Charismatic Leadership Theory:
  - Followers make attributions of heroic or extraordinary leadership abilities when they observe certain behaviors
- Four characteristics of charismatic leaders:
  - Have a vision
  - Are willing to take personal risks to achieve the vision
  - Are sensitive to follower needs
  - Exhibit behaviors that are out of the ordinary
- Traits and personality are related to charisma.

Transactional & Transformational Leadership

- Transactional Leaders
  - Leaders who guide or motivate their followers in the direction of established goals by clarifying role and task requirements
- Transformational Leaders
  - Inspire followers to transcend their own self-interests for the good of the organization; they can have a profound and extraordinary effect on followers